



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Covington Latin School
School Website: <https://covingtonlatin.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX)

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly centers its mission on glorifying Jesus Christ; grounds its aims in cultivating wisdom and virtue through truth, goodness, and beauty; implements a Trivium-centered, Great Books/Western tradition curriculum with Latin, logic, and rhetoric; and practices classical pedagogy (memory work, debate/discussion, thesis/rhetoric). Its collaborative "co-teacher parent" model strongly supports the classical partnership with families. The only thinner area is faculty language (less explicit emphasis on "teachers as mentors/living curriculum"), which modestly lowers that single category to Somewhat Classical. - Website used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

How to read this report - For each of the six elements, you will see: (1) keywords found on the school's site; (2) comparison to the "Six Essential Elements" positive/negative keyword lists; (3) a quantitative positive vs. negative estimate; (4) a rating for that category. - Keyword lists and criteria are drawn from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and companion lexicon materials. Examples of positive indicators include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, Trivium, Great Books, Latin, recitation/chanting, debate/Socratic, scholé/restful learning, and wonder; negative indicators include values-neutral, career readiness emphasis, project-based-only/experiential-only, social studies replacing history, etc.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS 1) Keywords found on the school site (evidence) - Mission and aim: "exists to glorify Jesus Christ," "classical, Christian education" - Transcendentals: "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" (aim and method) - Theological grounding and courses: Statement of Faith; "Christian Studies," "Exegesis & Hermeneutics," "Apologetics & Ethics" in Upper School - Formation language: "whole person... mind, body, and soul" 2) Comparison to Six Elements lists - Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue/wisdom formation; theology and Christian formation; sacred/Scripture classes (Christian worldview). These align with positive indicators for transcendental moral realism and theological grounding.

- Liturgical/communal practices are not explicit (no "daily chapel/chapel/liturgy" mentioned in captured crawl snippets). - No negative signals (e.g., values-neutral, secular humanism) observed. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: 11 (Jesus Christ, Christian, Statement of Faith, truth, goodness, beauty, Christian Studies, Exegesis, Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics, "soul") vs. Negative: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% - Coverage of sub-facets (moral realism + theology + liturgy): strong on first two, thin on liturgy → percent_coverage ≈ 85% 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL 1) Keywords found - Aim: "cultivate wisdom and virtue" - Method: "contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful" - Formation over utility: "less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose" - "Great conversation" language present 2) Comparison to Six Elements lists - All hallmark positives—wisdom, virtue, truth/goodness/beauty, formation not (merely) information—are explicit.

- No "college-and-career readiness"/21st-century skills marketing emphasis surfaced. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: 8; Negative: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% - Coverage of sub-facets: 100% 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM 1) Keywords found - Trivium named and defined: grammar, logic,

rhetoric; integrated curriculum; idea-focused instruction - Latin (5th–8th), logic (8th), rhetoric (10th) - Great Books/Great Conversation; Western tradition; Bible and primary sources in Christian Studies sequence - History as history: Ancient, Medieval, Modern, U.S. (not “social studies”) 2) Comparison to Six Elements lists - Direct positives: Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium), Great Books/primary texts, integrated/harmony of subjects (explicitly contrasted with subject silos), cultivation of wonder/beauty. - No negative signals like STEM-first framing, “social studies” replacing history, or project-based-only emphasis. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: 12; Negative: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% - Coverage: Trivium, Great Books, integration, historical engagement all present → percent_coverage ≈ 95% 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS 1) Keywords found - Grammar stage: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (chanting/singing as memory work) - Logic stage: debate and discussion; cultivating reasoning; rules of reasoning and argumentation - Rhetoric stage: “thesis defense,” “eloquent written and oral communication”

- Memory and repetition explicitly praised; rhetoric & composition named 2) Comparison to Six Elements lists - Strong positives: memory/recitation/chanting; dialectic/debate/discussion; rhetoric/speeches/thesis. - “Socratic” and “scholé” terms are not explicitly present in captured pages; however, debate/discussion and rhetoric formation satisfy the classical intent for grades 5–12, and K–8 mnemonic/chant work is explicit—this still aligns with classical pedagogy, especially given K–8 allowances in the rubric. - No negative signals (e.g., experiential/project-based only) observed. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: 12; Negative: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% - Coverage: memory, dialectic, rhetoric all explicit; restful scholé not explicit → percent_coverage ≈ 80% 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY 1) Keywords found - “Head of School who loves Jesus... talented and dedicated teachers who enjoy serving God by teaching students... using the classical approach” 2) Comparison to Six Elements lists - Some alignment with “teachers as models” and “mentorship” ideals is implicit, but explicit “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty as living curriculum,” or “faculty of friends/collegial culture” language is light in the captured crawl. - No negative language (e.g., “facilitators/guide-on-the-side” without classical context). 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: 3; Negative: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% - Coverage: partial (modeling/virtue implied, but formal portrait/mentoring culture not explicit) → percent_coverage ≈ 50% 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY 1) Keywords found - Partnership with parents: “co-laboring with families,” “co-teacher parent,” University-Model schedule (parents co-teach at home 2–3 days/week)

- Parent formation: required/encouraged readings on classical education; parent information meetings, tours, open houses

- Community formation: House system in Upper School student life 2) Comparison to Six Elements lists - Strong positives: parent partnership/co-educators; parent education; classical community culture. - No “parents as customers only/minimal involvement” language. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: 6; Negative: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% - Coverage: partnership + parent formation explicit; open-campus/visitation norms implied via tours but not broadly stated → percent_coverage ≈ 90% 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Overall Assessment - Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL - Five categories (1, 2, 3, 4, 6) are solidly classical using the Six Elements keyword framework; Faculty (Element 5) is “Somewhat Classical” due to lighter explicit language about teachers as mentors/living curriculum. The school’s mission, aims, curriculum, and pedagogy repeatedly use core classical keywords from the Six Elements lists—truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom/virtue; Trivium; Latin/logic/rhetoric; memory/recitation; debate/discussion; Great Books/Great Conversation—while avoiding negative indicators like values-neutral education, social-studies-over-history, or project-based-only pedagogy.

What would move the needle (Faculty) from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” (virtues, habits, intellectual life) and/or “Portrait of a Graduate” that frames faculty as mentors and the “living curriculum,” echoing the Six Elements’ teacher ideals. - Describe ongoing faculty formation: great books seminars for teachers, colloquia on pedagogy, catechesis/classical training expectations. - Name the mentoring model explicitly (e.g., “master-teacher,” “apprenticeship,” “faculty of friends/collegial culture”) to align with positive faculty keywords.

Sources from the school site (examples) - Mission/identity and classical language: “glorify Jesus Christ... wise, virtuous, humble... classical, Christian education” - Classical Education Basics (Truth, Goodness, Beauty; Trivium; Great Conversation)

- Trivium stages; memory/recitation/songs; debate/discussion; rhetoric/thesis; Latin/logic/rhetoric sequencing

- Integrated knowledge under God's sovereignty; “whole person: mind, body, soul”

- Parent partnership/co-teacher model; parent formation readings; tours/open houses; House system

Alignment with the Six Elements framework - Positive keyword families used here reflect the framework's lists for Foundations, Purpose/Goals, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community, and the audit avoided the framework's negative signals.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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